



FREE MONEY GUIDE

YOUR FIRST PAYCHECK CHECKLIST

The money guide every young person should read before their first salary arrives.



"Your first paycheck isn't about how much you earn - it's about the money habits you build from day one."

01 Set up your bank account

- ☐ Make sure your account is in your own name
- ☐ Download your banking app
- ☐ Turn on payment notifications

MONEY SMART TIP

The most financially confident people know where their money is going.

02 Understand your payslip

- ☐ Gross pay
- ☐ Net pay
- ☐ Tax deductions (if applicable)
- ☐ National Insurance
- ☐ Pension contributions

CASHBRITE RULE

Never ignore your payslip. Always check you have been paid correctly.

03 Create your spending plan

NEEDS

Transport | Phone | Food | Bills

WANTS

Clothes | Eating out | Entertainment

SAVINGS

Money for future goals

MONEY SMART TIP

Budgeting isn't about restricting your life. It's about telling your money where to go.



YOUR FIRST PAYCHECK CHECKLIST

When your paycheck arrives

04

Pay yourself first

£10 per week

£520 saved in a year

£20 per week

£1,040 saved in a year

Small habits
create financial
confidence.

05

Build an emergency fund

- ☐ A broken phone
- ☐ Travel costs
- ☐ Unexpected expenses

WHY IT HELPS

Savings give you choices and reduce the need to borrow.

06

Your first credit card

- ☐ A credit card is borrowed money
- ☐ You receive a monthly statement
- ☐ Pay the full balance where possible
- ☐ Avoid only paying the minimum amount

CASHBRITE RULE

Only spend on a credit card what you can afford to repay when the bill arrives.

YOUR NEXT STEP

How Money Ready Are You?

This checklist is just the beginning.

- Your Money Readiness Score
- Your biggest money knowledge gaps
- Your personalised route to improving your confidence

[Take the Free Assessment](#)

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